

PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PHASE

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Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

1. Introduction

The Development Phase focuses on implementing the proposed automated IT procurement workflow in **ServiceNow**. The project develops a Flow Designer workflow that processes Standard Laptop requests and automatically creates a Catalog Task for the Hardware team.

The development is designed to reduce manual intervention, minimize delays in laptop configuration, and improve task allocation within the IT procurement process.

2. Development Environment

The project is developed using the ServiceNow platform with the following components:

- **ServiceNow**
- **Flow Designer**
- **Service Catalog**
- **Maintain Items**
- **Standard Laptop Catalog Item**
- **Catalog Task**
- **Hardware Assignment Group**

The PDF specifies Flow Designer as the primary automation component and uses the Service Catalog to initiate the Standard Laptop request.

3. Development Modules

The development is divided into three major modules:

Module 1 – Flow Development

A Flow Designer workflow named “**Standard Laptop Task**” is created.

Module 2 – Flow Assignment

The created flow is associated with the **Standard Laptop Service Catalog** item.

Module 3 – Service Catalog Processing

A Standard Laptop request is submitted, approved, and used to verify the automatically generated Catalog Task.

These modules correspond to the three milestones documented in the project PDF.

4. Module 1 – Flow Development

4.1 Create the Flow

The first development activity is to create a new Flow in ServiceNow Flow Designer.

The flow is configured with the following properties:

Property	Configuration
Flow Name	Standard Laptop Task
Application	Global
Run As	System User

The project document specifies these configuration values during Flow creation.

4.2 Configure the Trigger

After creating the flow, a trigger is added.

The trigger is configured as:

Trigger → Service Catalog

This allows the flow to respond to the Service Catalog process associated with the Standard Laptop request.

4.3 Configure the Action

After configuring the trigger, an action is added to the flow.

The selected action is:

Create Catalog Task

The Requested Item Record is used as the Request Item, and the table is automatically populated as a Catalog Task.

4.4 Configure Catalog Task Fields

The Catalog Task is developed with the required field values.

Field	Value
Short Description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment Group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

These values are specified in the project's Flow Designer configuration.

The resulting task provides the Hardware team with the required information for laptop configuration.

4.5 Save and Activate the Flow

After configuring the action and fields:

1. The flow is saved.
2. The flow is activated.
3. The activated flow becomes available for use with the Standard Laptop Service Catalog process.

The PDF specifically requires the flow to be saved and activated after configuration.

5. Module 2 – Flow Assignment

5.1 Open Maintain Items

The second development module connects the newly created flow to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.

The **Maintain Items** section is opened in ServiceNow.

The Standard Laptop item is then located.

5.2 Configure Process Engine

Within the Standard Laptop record:

1. Open **Process Engine**.
2. Remove the remaining automation as specified.

3. Add the newly created flow.
4. Select **Standard Laptop Task**.
5. Save the record.

This configuration connects the Standard Laptop catalog item to the developed Flow Designer automation.

6. Module 3 – Service Catalog Development

6.1 Access Standard Laptop

The third module develops the user-facing request process.

The Standard Laptop item is accessed through:

Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop

The user then selects:

Order Now

This initiates the Standard Laptop request.

6.2 Request Processing

After the request is submitted, the system displays the order status.

The Request Number can be opened to access the request record.

The Approvers section is then accessed to process the approval.

6.3 Catalog Task Generation

After the request process, the Requested Item record is opened.

The **Catalog Tasks** section is accessed to view the generated task.

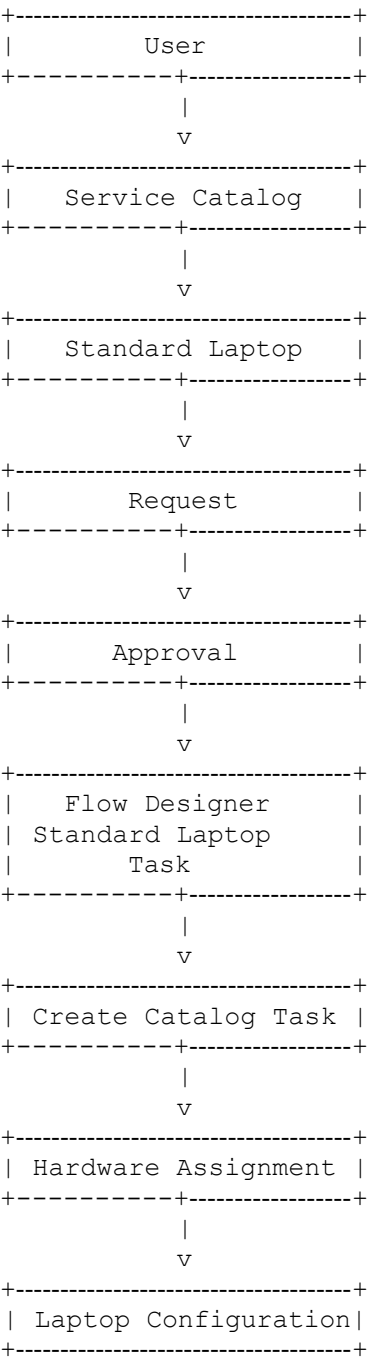
The task is checked for:

- Short Description
- Assignment Group
- Updated status

The PDF specifically describes checking the generated Catalog Task for the updated status, short description, and assigned group.

7. Developed Workflow

The completed development produces the following workflow:



The core automation consists of the Service Catalog trigger followed by the Create Catalog Task action.

8. Data Flow During Development

The data moves through the system as follows:

Standard Laptop Request

↓

Requested Item Record

↓

Approval Information

↓

Flow Designer

↓

Create Catalog Task

↓

Catalog Task

↓

Hardware Assignment Group

The Requested Item Record is explicitly used by the Create Catalog Task action in the documented implementation.

9. Development Output

The main outputs produced during development are:

Output 1 – Automated Flow

A Flow Designer flow named **Standard Laptop Task**.

Output 2 – Service Catalog Integration

The Standard Laptop Service Catalog item is connected to the created flow.

Output 3 – Automated Catalog Task

The workflow creates a Catalog Task with the required configuration information.

Output 4 – Hardware Assignment

The generated task is assigned to the **Hardware** group.

Output 5 – Request Verification

The resulting Catalog Task can be accessed through the Requested Item record and checked for its status, short description, and assignment group.

10. Development Verification

The developed system is verified by following the request process from beginning to end:

Verification Point	Expected Result
Standard Laptop available	Catalog item is available
Order Now	Request is created
Approval	Request approval can be processed
Flow execution	Standard Laptop Task flow operates
Catalog Task	Task is generated
Short Description	“Laptop need to Configured”
Assignment Group	Hardware
Task Status	Updated task can be viewed

This verification follows the testing and checking procedure documented in the PDF.

11. Development Benefits

The implemented development addresses the problems identified at the beginning of the project.

The developed workflow:

- Automates task generation.
- Reduces manual intervention.
- Automatically assigns the task to the Hardware team.
- Reduces delays in laptop configuration.
- Improves resource allocation.
- Helps reduce user waiting time.

- Provides a streamlined procurement process.

These benefits are consistent with the project's stated objectives and conclusion.

12. Development Phase Conclusion

The Development Phase implements the proposed Standard Laptop procurement automation using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

The **Standard Laptop Task** flow is created with a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action. The task is configured with the required description, approval value, and Hardware assignment group. The flow is then connected to the Standard Laptop Service Catalog item.

The completed development provides an automated path from the Standard Laptop request to the Hardware configuration task, thereby addressing the manual overhead and delays identified in the original procurement process.